



Network Security Engineer

QP Code: SSC/Q0917

Version: 4.0

NSQF Level: 6

IT-ITeS SSC NASSCOM || NASSCOM Plot No - 7, 8, 9 & 10, 3rd Floor, Sector 126
Noida Uttar Pradesh - 201303 || email:sscstandards@nasscom.in

Qualification Pack

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SSC/Q0917: Network Security Engineer

Brief Job Description

The qualification presents a comprehensive approach to network security and compliance management, designed to equip individuals with the essential skills and knowledge required to protect organizational information systems. It encompasses a wide range of topics, including foundational concepts of network security, risk management, compliance with regulatory standards (such as GDPR and PCI-DSS), and practical implementation of security measures like firewalls and intrusion detection systems. Participants engage in evaluating existing security postures, conducting audits, and understanding stakeholder roles in cybersecurity practices. Additionally, the qualification emphasizes hands-on experience with industry-standard tools and software, preparing individuals for real-world challenges in safeguarding digital assets and maintaining regulatory compliance.

Personal Attributes

This job may require the individual to work independently and take decisions for his/her own area of work. The individual should have a high level of analytical thinking ability, problem solving ability, passion for information security and attention for detail, should be ethical, compliance and result oriented, should also be able to demonstrate interpersonal and managerial skills.

Applicable National Occupational Standards (NOS)

Compulsory NOS:

1. [SSC/N0918: Maintain compliance to information security policies, regulations and standards and address risk issues](#)
2. [SSC/N0922: Conduct network security assessment and provide recommendations as per requirements](#)
3. [SSC/N0923: Carry out configuration review and provide recommendations to support in remediating the identified vulnerabilities](#)
4. [SSC/N0925: Test, run exploits to identify vulnerabilities in networks](#)
5. [SSC/N0927: Foster collaboration between various stakeholders to ensure cohesive cybersecurity practices across the organization](#)
6. [DGT/VSQ/N0102: Employability Skills \(60 Hours\)](#)

Qualification Pack (QP) Parameters

Qualification Pack

Sector	IT-ITeS
Sub-Sector	Future Skills
Occupation	Information and Cyber Security
Country	India
NSQF Level	6
Credits	20
Aligned to NCO/ISCO/ISIC Code	NCO-2015/NIL
Minimum Educational Qualification & Experience	Completed 4 year UG program (PG or UG or diploma with courses related to Engg./ Science) OR Previous relevant Qualification of NSQF Level (5.5) with 1.5 years of experience Relevant Experience in job roles related to IT/Computer Science/Cybersecurity The relevant experience would include work, internship and apprenticeship after completing relevant educational qualifications OR Previous relevant Qualification of NSQF Level (5) with 3 Years of experience Relevant Experience in job roles related to IT/Computer Science/Cybersecurity The relevant experience would include work, internship and apprenticeship after completing relevant educational qualifications
Minimum Level of Education for Training in School	Not Applicable
Pre-Requisite License or Training	NIL
Minimum Job Entry Age	22 Years
Last Reviewed On	NA
Next Review Date	07/10/2028
NSQC Approval Date	07/10/2025
Version	4.0
Reference code on NQR	QG-06-IT-045872025-V2-NASSCOM
NQR Version	2

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SSC/N0918: Maintain compliance to information security policies, regulations and standards and address risk issues

Description

This unit is about maintaining compliance to information security policies, regulations and standards and address risk issues in organizations.

Scope

The scope covers the following :

- Maintain compliance to information security policies, regulations and standards and address risk issues

Elements and Performance Criteria

To be competent, the user/individual on the job must be able to:

- PC1.** Communicate compliance audit and risk assessment results to relevant personnel.
- PC2.** Identify and share compliance issues found during audits with appropriate personnel.
- PC3.** Plan and coordinate organizational activities to ensure compliance with regulations and standards.
- PC4.** Document and implement all policies and procedures effectively
- PC5.** Conduct internal reviews to identify compliance issues and initiate corrective actions.
- PC6.** Submit compliance reports to regulatory bodies
- PC7.** Monitor risk factors in organizational operations and take necessary corrective actions.
- PC8.** Present identified compliance issues to management for prioritization and risk mitigation.
- PC9.** Maintain regular communication with various stakeholders to coordinate compliance activities
- PC10.** Document all processes and outcomes for audits.
- PC11.** Utilize AI-driven tools for continuous monitoring of compliance and risk assessment.
- PC12.** Implement cloud-based compliance management solutions to streamline reporting and documentation

Knowledge and Understanding (KU)

The individual on the job needs to know and understand:

- KU1.** relevant legislation, standards, policies, and procedures followed in the company
- KU2.** organizations knowledge base and how to access and update this
- KU3.** limits of your role and responsibilities and who to seek guidance from
- KU4.** the organizational systems, procedures and tasks/checklists within the domain and how to use these
- KU5.** Organizational hierarchy and management structure

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- KU6.** Legal and regulatory guidelines applicable to the business or domain that the organization is engaged in
- KU7.** how to engage with both internal and external specialists for support in order to resolve incidents and service requests
- KU8.** service request procedures, tools, and techniques
- KU9.** the operating procedures that are applicable to the system(s) being used
- KU10.** Typical response times and service times related to own work area
- KU11.** Computer network defense (CND) policies, procedures, and regulations
- KU12.** Understanding of regulatory frameworks (e.g., GDPR, HIPAA, PCI-DSS).
- KU13.** Familiarity with industry security standards (e.g., ISO 27001, NIST).
- KU14.** Knowledge of risk assessment methodologies and techniques.
- KU15.** Proficiency in using compliance management software and tools.
- KU16.** Awareness of AI and cloud technologies relevant to compliance monitoring.
- KU17.** Understanding of documentation practices and auditing procedures.
- KU18.** Familiarity with reporting requirements of regulatory bodies.

Generic Skills (GS)

User/individual on the job needs to know how to:

- GS1.** Ability to effectively convey compliance information to diverse audiences, including technical and non-technical stakeholders.
- GS2.** Skills in analyzing compliance data and risk assessment results to inform decision-making.
- GS3.** Ensuring thoroughness in documenting compliance processes and outcomes.
- GS4.** Identifying compliance issues and developing practical solutions for remediation.
- GS5.** Working effectively with cross-functional teams and stakeholders to ensure cohesive compliance efforts.
- GS6.** Prioritizing tasks to meet deadlines while managing multiple compliance activities.
- GS7.** Ability to adjust to changes in regulations, standards, and technology in the compliance landscape.

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Assessment Criteria

Assessment Criteria for Outcomes	Theory Marks	Practical Marks	Project Marks	Viva Marks
	30	50	-	20
PC1. Communicate compliance audit and risk assessment results to relevant personnel.	2	3	-	1
PC2. Identify and share compliance issues found during audits with appropriate personnel.	2	3	-	1
PC3. Plan and coordinate organizational activities to ensure compliance with regulations and standards.	2	3	-	1
PC4. Document and implement all policies and procedures effectively	2	3	-	1
PC5. Conduct internal reviews to identify compliance issues and initiate corrective actions.	2	4	-	2
PC6. Submit compliance reports to regulatory bodies	2	4	-	2
PC7. Monitor risk factors in organizational operations and take necessary corrective actions.	3	5	-	2
PC8. Present identified compliance issues to management for prioritization and risk mitigation.	3	5	-	2
PC9. Maintain regular communication with various stakeholders to coordinate compliance activities	3	5	-	2
PC10. Document all processes and outcomes for audits.	3	5	-	2
PC11. Utilize AI-driven tools for continuous monitoring of compliance and risk assessment.	3	5	-	2
PC12. Implement cloud-based compliance management solutions to streamline reporting and documentation	3	5	-	2
NOS Total	30	50	-	20

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National Occupational Standards (NOS) Parameters

NOS Code	SSC/N0918
NOS Name	Maintain compliance to information security policies, regulations and standards and address risk issues
Sector	IT-ITeS
Sub-Sector	Future Skills
Occupation	Information and Cyber Security
NSQF Level	6
Credits	4
Version	3.0
Last Reviewed Date	07/10/2025
Next Review Date	07/10/2028
NSQC Clearance Date	07/10/2025

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SSC/N0922: Conduct network security assessment and provide recommendations as per requirements

Description

Evaluate network security needs and provide tailored recommendations to address vulnerabilities and risks.

Scope

The scope covers the following :

- recommend network security solutions

Elements and Performance Criteria

To be competent, the user/individual on the job must be able to:

- PC1.** Consult with clients to understand functional requirements for network security.
- PC2.** Define project objectives based on customer requirements and existing security measures.
- PC3.** Evaluate current network protocols, topology, and existing security measures.
- PC4.** Conduct risk analysis and threat identification related to network security
- PC5.** Identify and document security vulnerabilities and constraints that may impact the organization
- PC6.** Research and assess potential security solutions based on organizational needs.
- PC7.** Prepare comprehensive recommendations that address security objectives, considering costs and benefits
- PC8.** Maintain confidentiality of sensitive information during the analysis and recommendation process
- PC9.** Assess the security of cloud environments and provide recommendations for cloud security policies
- PC10.** Incorporate AI techniques to analyze historical security incident data for improved risk assessment

Knowledge and Understanding (KU)

The individual on the job needs to know and understand:

- KU1.** Relevant legislation, standards, policies, and procedures followed in the company
- KU2.** Organizations knowledge base and how to access and update this
- KU3.** Limits of your role and responsibilities and who to seek guidance from
- KU4.** The operating procedures that are applicable to the system(s) being used
- KU5.** Standard tools and templates available and how to use these

Generic Skills (GS)

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User/individual on the job needs to know how to:

- GS1.** Effectively convey technical information and recommendations to clients and stakeholders.
- GS2.** Critically evaluate network security posture and identify vulnerabilities.
- GS3.** Propose solutions for identified security risks and gaps.
- GS4.** Manage timelines and deliverables effectively.
- GS5.** Build trust and rapport with clients to understand their security needs.

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Assessment Criteria

Assessment Criteria for Outcomes	Theory Marks	Practical Marks	Project Marks	Viva Marks
	30	50	-	20
PC1. Consult with clients to understand functional requirements for network security.	3	5	-	2
PC2. Define project objectives based on customer requirements and existing security measures.	3	5	-	2
PC3. Evaluate current network protocols, topology, and existing security measures.	3	5	-	2
PC4. Conduct risk analysis and threat identification related to network security	3	5	-	2
PC5. Identify and document security vulnerabilities and constraints that may impact the organization	3	5	-	2
PC6. Research and assess potential security solutions based on organizational needs.	3	5	-	2
PC7. Prepare comprehensive recommendations that address security objectives, considering costs and benefits	3	5	-	2
PC8. Maintain confidentiality of sensitive information during the analysis and recommendation process	3	5	-	2
PC9. Assess the security of cloud environments and provide recommendations for cloud security policies	3	5	-	2
PC10. Incorporate AI techniques to analyze historical security incident data for improved risk assessment	3	5	-	2
NOS Total	30	50	-	20

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National Occupational Standards (NOS) Parameters

NOS Code	SSC/N0922
NOS Name	Conduct network security assessment and provide recommendations as per requirements
Sector	IT-ITeS
Sub-Sector	Future Skills
Occupation	Information and Cyber Security
NSQF Level	6
Credits	5
Version	3.0
Last Reviewed Date	07/10/2025
Next Review Date	07/10/2028
NSQC Clearance Date	07/10/2025

Qualification Pack

SSC/N0923: Carry out configuration review and provide recommendations to support in remediating the identified vulnerabilities

Description

Establish secure configurations for network devices and provide recommendations to support in remediating the identified vulnerabilities

Scope

The scope covers the following :

- Recommend configuration for network and security devices

Elements and Performance Criteria

To be competent, the user/individual on the job must be able to:

- PC1.** Conduct an inventory of network items requiring security configuration
- PC2.** Review configurations of identified items for security vulnerabilities
- PC3.** Provide recommendations for secure configurations aligning with organizational business needs
- PC4.** Test configurations prior to implementation, diagnosing and addressing issues as needed
- PC5.** Perform vulnerability assessments using various methodologies and tools to identify weaknesses.
- PC6.** Recommend hardening measures for network devices to minimize vulnerabilities.
- PC7.** Document all assessments and configurations for future reference and compliance.
- PC8.** Implement cloud security configuration standards to ensure secure setups in cloud environments
- PC9.** Utilize AI tools for automated vulnerability scanning and threat detection in network configurations

Knowledge and Understanding (KU)

The individual on the job needs to know and understand:

- KU1.** organizations knowledge base and how to access and update this
- KU2.** limits of your role and responsibilities and who to seek guidance from
- KU3.** the operating procedures that are applicable to the system(s) being used
- KU4.** typical response times and service times related to own work area
- KU5.** standard tools and templates available and how to use these

Generic Skills (GS)

User/individual on the job needs to know how to:

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- GS1.** Clearly articulate recommendations and findings to technical and non-technical stakeholders.
- GS2.** Critically analyze security configurations and identify areas for improvement.
- GS3.** Develop effective solutions for identified vulnerabilities.
- GS4.** Collaborate effectively with IT and engineering teams.
- GS5.** Stay updated on emerging security threats and configuration technologies.

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Assessment Criteria

Assessment Criteria for Outcomes	Theory Marks	Practical Marks	Project Marks	Viva Marks
	30	50	-	20
PC1. Conduct an inventory of network items requiring security configuration	3	5	-	2
PC2. Review configurations of identified items for security vulnerabilities	3	5	-	2
PC3. Provide recommendations for secure configurations aligning with organizational business needs	3	5	-	2
PC4. Test configurations prior to implementation, diagnosing and addressing issues as needed	3	5	-	2
PC5. Perform vulnerability assessments using various methodologies and tools to identify weaknesses.	3	6	-	2
PC6. Recommend hardening measures for network devices to minimize vulnerabilities.	3	6	-	2
PC7. Document all assessments and configurations for future reference and compliance.	4	6	-	2
PC8. Implement cloud security configuration standards to ensure secure setups in cloud environments	4	6	-	3
PC9. Utilize AI tools for automated vulnerability scanning and threat detection in network configurations	4	6	-	3
NOS Total	30	50	-	20

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National Occupational Standards (NOS) Parameters

NOS Code	SSC/N0923
NOS Name	Carry out configuration review and provide recommendations to support in remediating the identified vulnerabilities
Sector	IT-ITeS
Sub-Sector	Future Skills
Occupation	Information and Cyber Security
NSQF Level	6
Credits	5
Version	3.0
Last Reviewed Date	07/10/2025
Next Review Date	07/10/2028
NSQC Clearance Date	07/10/2025

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SSC/N0925: Test, run exploits to identify vulnerabilities in networks

Description

This unit is about performing network vulnerability assessment.

Scope

The scope covers the following :

- Perform network vulnerability assessment

Elements and Performance Criteria

To be competent, the user/individual on the job must be able to:

- PC1.** gather preliminary information by manually reviewing the documentation, secure coding policies, security requirements, architectural designs
- PC2.** gather network information using various information gathering methods and tools
- PC3.** define scope for the tests using Existing Security Policies & Industry Standards
- PC4.** plan for the test while adhering to business and time constraints put by organization
- PC5.** perform Active Reconnaissance on the target network using metadata, search engines, social engineering, dumpster diving etc. after taking adequate approvals
- PC6.** develop a map of target environments
- PC7.** utilize network infrastructure scanning tool to conduct comprehensive network sweeps, port scans, Operating System fingerprinting and version scanning
- PC8.** identify live systems, open / filtered ports found, services running on these ports, mapping router / firewall rules, operating system details, network path discovery, etc.
- PC9.** perform fingerprinting services running behind open ports and underlying operating system
- PC10.** explore the network by pre-determined scans to find possible vulnerabilities
- PC11.** perform social engineering using Social Engineering Toolkit SET to find possible security holes
- PC12.** test the network devices by supplying invalid inputs, random strings, etc., and check for any errors or unintended behaviour in the output
- PC13.** find exploits e.g. proof-of-concept exploit for the various vulnerabilities found
- PC14.** identify weak entry points and high value target assets of the organization or its network
- PC15.** identify antiviruses e.g. host-based intrusion prevention systems, web application firewalls, and other preventative technologies in the system
- PC16.** use pivoting techniques through targeted systems
- PC17.** demonstrate various possible impacts, compromises and exposures using specialized exploitation tools
- PC18.** evaluate ways & means of identifying and closing weaknesses in the network
- PC19.** recommend hardening measures for network security devices for minimizing exposure and vulnerabilities
- PC20.** maintain logs for all the activities performed

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Knowledge and Understanding (KU)

The individual on the job needs to know and understand:

- KU1.** basic cyber security concepts
- KU2.** explain how hardware and software vulnerabilities can be identified and resolved
- KU3.** encryption algorithms
- KU4.** information technology (IT) security principles and methods
- KU5.** operating systems

Generic Skills (GS)

User/individual on the job needs to know how to:

- GS1.** complete accurate well written work with attention to detail
- GS2.** prepare status and progress reports
- GS3.** log calls and raise tickets in the SIEM tool, providing proper indicators and descriptions as required
- GS4.** keep stakeholders informed about progress
- GS5.** read emails received from own team, across team and external vendors and clients

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Assessment Criteria

Assessment Criteria for Outcomes	Theory Marks	Practical Marks	Project Marks	Viva Marks
	30	50	-	20
PC1. gather preliminary information by manually reviewing the documentation, secure coding policies, security requirements, architectural designs	1	2	-	1
PC2. gather network information using various information gathering methods and tools	1	2	-	1
PC3. define scope for the tests using Existing Security Policies & Industry Standards	1	2	-	1
PC4. plan for the test while adhering to business and time constraints put by organization	1	2	-	1
PC5. perform Active Reconnaissance on the target network using metadata, search engines, social engineering, dumpster diving etc. after taking adequate approvals	1	2	-	1
PC6. develop a map of target environments	1	2	-	1
PC7. utilize network infrastructure scanning tool to conduct comprehensive network sweeps, port scans, Operating System fingerprinting and version scanning	1	2	-	1
PC8. identify live systems, open / filtered ports found, services running on these ports, mapping router / firewall rules, operating system details, network path discovery, etc.	1	2	-	1
PC9. perform fingerprinting services running behind open ports and underlying operating system	1	2	-	1
PC10. explore the network by pre-determined scans to find possible vulnerabilities	1	2	-	1
PC11. perform social engineering using Social Engineering Toolkit SET to find possible security holes	2	3	-	1

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Assessment Criteria for Outcomes	Theory Marks	Practical Marks	Project Marks	Viva Marks
PC12. test the network devices by supplying invalid inputs, random strings, etc., and check for any errors or unintended behaviour in the output	2	3	-	1
PC13. find exploits e.g. proof-of-concept exploit for the various vulnerabilities found	2	3	-	1
PC14. identify weak entry points and high value target assets of the organization or its network	2	3	-	1
PC15. identify antivirus e.g. host-based intrusion prevention systems, web application firewalls, and other preventative technologies in the system	2	3	-	1
PC16. use pivoting techniques through targeted systems	2	3	-	1
PC17. demonstrate various possible impacts, compromises and exposures using specialized exploitation tools	2	3	-	1
PC18. evaluate ways & means of identifying and closing weaknesses in the network	2	3	-	1
PC19. recommend hardening measures for network security devices for minimizing exposure and vulnerabilities	2	3	-	1
PC20. maintain logs for all the activities performed	2	3	-	1
NOS Total	30	50	-	20

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National Occupational Standards (NOS) Parameters

NOS Code	SSC/N0925
NOS Name	Test, run exploits to identify vulnerabilities in networks
Sector	IT-ITeS
Sub-Sector	Future Skills
Occupation	Information and Cyber Security
NSQF Level	6
Credits	3
Version	3.0
Last Reviewed Date	07/10/2025
Next Review Date	07/10/2028
NSQC Clearance Date	07/10/2025

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SSC/N0927: Foster collaboration between various stakeholders to ensure cohesive cybersecurity practices across the organization

Description

Facilitate collaboration among diverse stakeholders to ensure unified cybersecurity practices throughout the organization.

Scope

The scope covers the following :

- Facilitate collaboration among diverse stakeholders to ensure unified cybersecurity practices throughout the organization.

Elements and Performance Criteria

To be competent, the user/individual on the job must be able to:

- PC1.** Identify key stakeholders and understand their roles and concerns in relation to cybersecurity.
- PC2.** Create an inventory of cybersecurity-related operations and responsibilities
- PC3.** Collaborate with stakeholders to discuss key decisions impacting cybersecurity practices
- PC4.** Track and follow up on actionable items agreed upon with stakeholders.
- PC5.** Monitor the effectiveness of interdepartmental relationships and seek feedback for improvement
- PC6.** Address conflicts of interest with stakeholders in a manner that minimizes disruption
- PC7.** Ensure agreements are fulfilled and communicate any potential difficulties promptly.
- PC8.** Promote awareness of AI and cloud technologies among stakeholders regarding their impact on cybersecurity
- PC9.** Collaborate with cloud service providers to ensure compliance with established security standards

Knowledge and Understanding (KU)

The individual on the job needs to know and understand:

- KU1.** Relevant legislation, standards, policies, and procedures followed in the company including cyber security policy
- KU2.** Organizations knowledge base and how to access and update this
- KU3.** Limits of your role and responsibilities and who to seek guidance from
- KU4.** the organizational systems, procedures and tasks/checklists within the domain and how to use these
- KU5.** the operating procedures that are applicable to the system(s) being used
- KU6.** typical response times and service times related to own work area

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- KU7.** different business functions and their roles and responsibilities in achieving the organizations overall aims function
- KU8.** Understanding of organizational structures and key stakeholders concerning cybersecurity.
- KU9.** Familiarity with cybersecurity frameworks and best practices.
- KU10.** Knowledge of communication and project management tools (e.g., Jira, Trello).
- KU11.** Awareness of AI and cloud technologies' impact on cybersecurity practices.
- KU12.** Proficiency in compliance standards pertinent to stakeholder management and cybersecurity.

Generic Skills (GS)

User/individual on the job needs to know how to:

- GS1.** Communication Skills: Effectively communicate with various stakeholders and facilitate discussions.
- GS2.** Negotiation Skills: Navigate conflicts and reach agreements that satisfy multiple parties.
- GS3.** Interpersonal Skills: Build strong relationships and trust with different stakeholder groups.
- GS4.** Analytical Skills: Evaluate feedback and relationships to enhance collaboration.
- GS5.** Problem-Solving Skills: Address conflicts and identify resolutions that support organizational goals.
- GS6.** Project Management Skills: Manage stakeholder engagements and track commitments.
- GS7.** Adaptability: Adjust strategies based on stakeholder feedback and evolving organizational needs.

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Assessment Criteria

Assessment Criteria for Outcomes	Theory Marks	Practical Marks	Project Marks	Viva Marks
	30	50	-	20
PC1. Identify key stakeholders and understand their roles and concerns in relation to cybersecurity.	3	5	-	2
PC2. Create an inventory of cybersecurity-related operations and responsibilities	3	5	-	2
PC3. Collaborate with stakeholders to discuss key decisions impacting cybersecurity practices	3	5	-	2
PC4. Track and follow up on actionable items agreed upon with stakeholders.	3	5	-	2
PC5. Monitor the effectiveness of interdepartmental relationships and seek feedback for improvement	3	6	-	2
PC6. Address conflicts of interest with stakeholders in a manner that minimizes disruption	3	6	-	2
PC7. Ensure agreements are fulfilled and communicate any potential difficulties promptly.	4	6	-	2
PC8. Promote awareness of AI and cloud technologies among stakeholders regarding their impact on cybersecurity	4	6	-	3
PC9. Collaborate with cloud service providers to ensure compliance with established security standards	4	6	-	3
NOS Total	30	50	-	20

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National Occupational Standards (NOS) Parameters

NOS Code	SSC/N0927
NOS Name	Foster collaboration between various stakeholders to ensure cohesive cybersecurity practices across the organization
Sector	IT-ITeS
Sub-Sector	Future Skills
Occupation	Information and Cyber Security
NSQF Level	6
Credits	1
Version	3.0
Last Reviewed Date	07/10/2025
Next Review Date	07/10/2028
NSQC Clearance Date	07/10/2025

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DGT/VSQ/N0102: Employability Skills (60 Hours)

Description

This unit is about employability skills, Constitutional values, becoming a professional in the 21st Century, digital, financial, and legal literacy, diversity and Inclusion, English and communication skills, customer service, entrepreneurship, and apprenticeship, getting ready for jobs and career development.

Scope

The scope covers the following :

- Introduction to Employability Skills
- Constitutional values - Citizenship
- Becoming a Professional in the 21st Century
- Basic English Skills
- Career Development & Goal Setting
- Communication Skills
- Diversity & Inclusion
- Financial and Legal Literacy
- Essential Digital Skills
- Entrepreneurship
- Customer Service
- Getting ready for Apprenticeship & Jobs

Elements and Performance Criteria

Introduction to Employability Skills

To be competent, the user/individual on the job must be able to:

- PC1.** identify employability skills required for jobs in various industries
- PC2.** identify and explore learning and employability portals

Constitutional values – Citizenship

To be competent, the user/individual on the job must be able to:

- PC3.** recognize the significance of constitutional values, including civic rights and duties, citizenship, responsibility towards society etc. and personal values and ethics such as honesty, integrity, caring and respecting others, etc.
- PC4.** follow environmentally sustainable practices

Becoming a Professional in the 21st Century

To be competent, the user/individual on the job must be able to:

- PC5.** recognize the significance of 21st Century Skills for employment
- PC6.** practice the 21st Century Skills such as Self-Awareness, Behaviour Skills, time management, critical and adaptive thinking, problem-solving, creative thinking, social and cultural awareness, emotional awareness, learning to learn for continuous learning etc. in personal and professional life

Basic English Skills

To be competent, the user/individual on the job must be able to:

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- PC7.** use basic English for everyday conversation in different contexts, in person and over the telephone
- PC8.** read and understand routine information, notes, instructions, mails, letters etc. written in English
- PC9.** write short messages, notes, letters, e-mails etc. in English

Career Development & Goal Setting

To be competent, the user/individual on the job must be able to:

- PC10.** understand the difference between job and career
- PC11.** prepare a career development plan with short- and long-term goals, based on aptitude

Communication Skills

To be competent, the user/individual on the job must be able to:

- PC12.** follow verbal and non-verbal communication etiquette and active listening techniques in various settings
- PC13.** work collaboratively with others in a team

Diversity & Inclusion

To be competent, the user/individual on the job must be able to:

- PC14.** communicate and behave appropriately with all genders and PwD
- PC15.** escalate any issues related to sexual harassment at workplace according to POSH Act

Financial and Legal Literacy

To be competent, the user/individual on the job must be able to:

- PC16.** select financial institutions, products and services as per requirement
- PC17.** carry out offline and online financial transactions, safely and securely
- PC18.** identify common components of salary and compute income, expenses, taxes, investments etc
- PC19.** identify relevant rights and laws and use legal aids to fight against legal exploitation

Essential Digital Skills

To be competent, the user/individual on the job must be able to:

- PC20.** operate digital devices and carry out basic internet operations securely and safely
- PC21.** use e- mail and social media platforms and virtual collaboration tools to work effectively
- PC22.** use basic features of word processor, spreadsheets, and presentations

Entrepreneurship

To be competent, the user/individual on the job must be able to:

- PC23.** identify different types of Entrepreneurship and Enterprises and assess opportunities for potential business through research
- PC24.** develop a business plan and a work model, considering the 4Ps of Marketing Product, Price, Place and Promotion
- PC25.** identify sources of funding, anticipate, and mitigate any financial/ legal hurdles for the potential business opportunity

Customer Service

To be competent, the user/individual on the job must be able to:

- PC26.** identify different types of customers
- PC27.** identify and respond to customer requests and needs in a professional manner.

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PC28. follow appropriate hygiene and grooming standards

Getting ready for apprenticeship & Jobs

To be competent, the user/individual on the job must be able to:

PC29. create a professional Curriculum vitae (Résumé)

PC30. search for suitable jobs using reliable offline and online sources such as Employment exchange, recruitment agencies, newspapers etc. and job portals, respectively

PC31. apply to identified job openings using offline /online methods as per requirement

PC32. answer questions politely, with clarity and confidence, during recruitment and selection

PC33. identify apprenticeship opportunities and register for it as per guidelines and requirements

Knowledge and Understanding (KU)

The individual on the job needs to know and understand:

KU1. need for employability skills and different learning and employability related portals

KU2. various constitutional and personal values

KU3. different environmentally sustainable practices and their importance

KU4. Twenty first (21st) century skills and their importance

KU5. how to use English language for effective verbal (face to face and telephonic) and written communication in formal and informal set up

KU6. importance of career development and setting long- and short-term goals

KU7. about effective communication

KU8. POSH Act

KU9. Gender sensitivity and inclusivity

KU10. different types of financial institutes, products, and services

KU11. how to compute income and expenditure

KU12. importance of maintaining safety and security in offline and online financial transactions

KU13. different legal rights and laws

KU14. different types of digital devices and the procedure to operate them safely and securely

KU15. how to create and operate an e- mail account and use applications such as word processors, spreadsheets etc.

KU16. how to identify business opportunities

KU17. types and needs of customers

KU18. how to apply for a job and prepare for an interview

KU19. apprenticeship scheme and the process of registering on apprenticeship portal

Generic Skills (GS)

User/individual on the job needs to know how to:

GS1. read and write different types of documents/instructions/correspondence

GS2. communicate effectively using appropriate language in formal and informal settings

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- GS3.** behave politely and appropriately with all
- GS4.** how to work in a virtual mode
- GS5.** perform calculations efficiently
- GS6.** solve problems effectively
- GS7.** pay attention to details
- GS8.** manage time efficiently
- GS9.** maintain hygiene and sanitization to avoid infection

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Assessment Criteria

Assessment Criteria for Outcomes	Theory Marks	Practical Marks	Project Marks	Viva Marks
<i>Introduction to Employability Skills</i>	1	1	-	-
PC1. identify employability skills required for jobs in various industries	-	-	-	-
PC2. identify and explore learning and employability portals	-	-	-	-
<i>Constitutional values – Citizenship</i>	1	1	-	-
PC3. recognize the significance of constitutional values, including civic rights and duties, citizenship, responsibility towards society etc. and personal values and ethics such as honesty, integrity, caring and respecting others, etc.	-	-	-	-
PC4. follow environmentally sustainable practices	-	-	-	-
<i>Becoming a Professional in the 21st Century</i>	2	4	-	-
PC5. recognize the significance of 21st Century Skills for employment	-	-	-	-
PC6. practice the 21st Century Skills such as Self-Awareness, Behaviour Skills, time management, critical and adaptive thinking, problem-solving, creative thinking, social and cultural awareness, emotional awareness, learning to learn for continuous learning etc. in personal and professional life	-	-	-	-
<i>Basic English Skills</i>	2	3	-	-
PC7. use basic English for everyday conversation in different contexts, in person and over the telephone	-	-	-	-
PC8. read and understand routine information, notes, instructions, mails, letters etc. written in English	-	-	-	-
PC9. write short messages, notes, letters, e-mails etc. in English	-	-	-	-
<i>Career Development & Goal Setting</i>	1	2	-	-

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Assessment Criteria for Outcomes	Theory Marks	Practical Marks	Project Marks	Viva Marks
PC10. understand the difference between job and career	-	-	-	-
PC11. prepare a career development plan with short- and long-term goals, based on aptitude	-	-	-	-
<i>Communication Skills</i>	2	2	-	-
PC12. follow verbal and non-verbal communication etiquette and active listening techniques in various settings	-	-	-	-
PC13. work collaboratively with others in a team	-	-	-	-
<i>Diversity & Inclusion</i>	1	2	-	-
PC14. communicate and behave appropriately with all genders and PwD	-	-	-	-
PC15. escalate any issues related to sexual harassment at workplace according to POSH Act	-	-	-	-
<i>Financial and Legal Literacy</i>	2	3	-	-
PC16. select financial institutions, products and services as per requirement	-	-	-	-
PC17. carry out offline and online financial transactions, safely and securely	-	-	-	-
PC18. identify common components of salary and compute income, expenses, taxes, investments etc	-	-	-	-
PC19. identify relevant rights and laws and use legal aids to fight against legal exploitation	-	-	-	-
<i>Essential Digital Skills</i>	3	4	-	-
PC20. operate digital devices and carry out basic internet operations securely and safely	-	-	-	-
PC21. use e- mail and social media platforms and virtual collaboration tools to work effectively	-	-	-	-
PC22. use basic features of word processor, spreadsheets, and presentations	-	-	-	-

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Assessment Criteria for Outcomes	Theory Marks	Practical Marks	Project Marks	Viva Marks
<i>Entrepreneurship</i>	2	3	-	-
PC23. identify different types of Entrepreneurship and Enterprises and assess opportunities for potential business through research	-	-	-	-
PC24. develop a business plan and a work model, considering the 4Ps of Marketing Product, Price, Place and Promotion	-	-	-	-
PC25. identify sources of funding, anticipate, and mitigate any financial/ legal hurdles for the potential business opportunity	-	-	-	-
<i>Customer Service</i>	1	2	-	-
PC26. identify different types of customers	-	-	-	-
PC27. identify and respond to customer requests and needs in a professional manner.	-	-	-	-
PC28. follow appropriate hygiene and grooming standards	-	-	-	-
<i>Getting ready for apprenticeship & Jobs</i>	2	3	-	-
PC29. create a professional Curriculum vitae (Résumé)	-	-	-	-
PC30. search for suitable jobs using reliable offline and online sources such as Employment exchange, recruitment agencies, newspapers etc. and job portals, respectively	-	-	-	-
PC31. apply to identified job openings using offline /online methods as per requirement	-	-	-	-
PC32. answer questions politely, with clarity and confidence, during recruitment and selection	-	-	-	-
PC33. identify apprenticeship opportunities and register for it as per guidelines and requirements	-	-	-	-
NOS Total	20	30	-	-

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National Occupational Standards (NOS) Parameters

NOS Code	DGT/VSQ/N0102
NOS Name	Employability Skills (60 Hours)
Sector	Cross Sectoral
Sub-Sector	Professional Skills
Occupation	Employability
NSQF Level	4
Credits	2
Version	1.0
Last Reviewed Date	12/03/2026
Next Review Date	12/03/2029
NSQC Clearance Date	12/03/2026

Assessment Guidelines and Assessment Weightage

Assessment Guidelines

The assessment will consist of a blend of hands-on practical evaluations, viva-voce, and online proctored scenario-based multiple-choice questions ensuring a thorough evaluation of the individual's proficiency in learning outcomes, practical understanding, and real-world application of concepts.

Minimum Aggregate Passing % at QP Level : 70

(Please note: Every Trainee should score a minimum aggregate passing percentage as specified above, to successfully clear the Qualification Pack assessment.)

Assessment Weightage

Compulsory NOS

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National Occupational Standards	Theory Marks	Practical Marks	Project Marks	Viva Marks	Total Marks	Weightage
SSC/N0918.Maintain compliance to information security policies, regulations and standards and address risk issues	30	50	-	20	100	18
SSC/N0922.Conduct network security assessment and provide recommendations as per requirements	30	50	-	20	100	18
SSC/N0923.Carry out configuration review and provide recommendations to support in remediating the identified vulnerabilities	30	50	-	20	100	18
SSC/N0925.Test, run exploits to identify vulnerabilities in networks	30	50	-	20	100	18
SSC/N0927.Foster collaboration between various stakeholders to ensure cohesive cybersecurity practices across the organization	30	50	-	20	100	18
DGT/VSQ/N0102.Employability Skills (60 Hours)	20	30	-	-	50	10
Total	170	280	-	100	550	100

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Acronyms

NOS	National Occupational Standard(s)
NSQF	National Skills Qualifications Framework
QP	Qualifications Pack
TVET	Technical and Vocational Education and Training

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Glossary

Sector	Sector is a conglomeration of different business operations having similar business and interests. It may also be defined as a distinct subset of the economy whose components share similar characteristics and interests.
Sub-sector	Sub-sector is derived from a further breakdown based on the characteristics and interests of its components.
Occupation	Occupation is a set of job roles, which perform similar/ related set of functions in an industry.
Job role	Job role defines a unique set of functions that together form a unique employment opportunity in an organisation.
Occupational Standards (OS)	OS specify the standards of performance an individual must achieve when carrying out a function in the workplace, together with the Knowledge and Understanding (KU) they need to meet that standard consistently. Occupational Standards are applicable both in the Indian and global contexts.
Performance Criteria (PC)	Performance Criteria (PC) are statements that together specify the standard of performance required when carrying out a task.
National Occupational Standards (NOS)	NOS are occupational standards which apply uniquely in the Indian context.
Qualifications Pack (QP)	QP comprises the set of OS, together with the educational, training and other criteria required to perform a job role. A QP is assigned a unique qualifications pack code.
Unit Code	Unit code is a unique identifier for an Occupational Standard, which is denoted by an 'N'
Unit Title	Unit title gives a clear overall statement about what the incumbent should be able to do.
Description	Description gives a short summary of the unit content. This would be helpful to anyone searching on a database to verify that this is the appropriate OS they are looking for.
Scope	Scope is a set of statements specifying the range of variables that an individual may have to deal with in carrying out the function which have a critical impact on quality of performance required.

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Knowledge and Understanding (KU)	Knowledge and Understanding (KU) are statements which together specify the technical, generic, professional and organisational specific knowledge that an individual needs in order to perform to the required standard.
Organisational Context	Organisational context includes the way the organisation is structured and how it operates, including the extent of operative knowledge managers have of their relevant areas of responsibility.
Technical Knowledge	Technical knowledge is the specific knowledge needed to accomplish specific designated responsibilities.
Core Skills/ Generic Skills (GS)	Core skills or Generic Skills (GS) are a group of skills that are the key to learning and working in today's world. These skills are typically needed in any work environment in today's world. These skills are typically needed in any work environment. In the context of the OS, these include communication related skills that are applicable to most job roles.
Electives	Electives are NOS/set of NOS that are identified by the sector as contributive to specialization in a job role. There may be multiple electives within a QP for each specialized job role. Trainees must select at least one elective for the successful completion of a QP with Electives.
Options	Options are NOS/set of NOS that are identified by the sector as additional skills. There may be multiple options within a QP. It is not mandatory to select any of the options to complete a QP with Options.